

BUILD AI

LINE 01 → COHORT 01

We don't teach AI.

We make engineers who ship.

An AI-native product engineering apprenticeship for India.



Traditional curriculum alone cannot keep pace with AI-native engineering workflows.

→ WHERE CURRICULUM ENDS

- Theoretical foundations are strong
- Limited time for shipping practice
- Production deployment rarely taught
- AI-assisted tools change every quarter
- AI debugging is a different discipline
- Startup workflows are hard to simulate in-class

→ WHAT STARTUPS NEED

- AI-assisted development fluency
- Shipping velocity over algorithm depth
- Product and architecture judgment
- Evaluation discipline for AI features
- Async collaboration habits
- Debug AI hallucination, not just human bugs

Five priorities that AI-native programmes help address.

- | | | |
|----|-----------------------------------|---|
| 01 | Placement statistics | Stagnant or declining numbers, with student exits to tier-1 alternatives. |
| 02 | Industry partnerships | AICTE and NAAC rankings increasingly weight industry tie-ups. |
| 03 | AI branding gap | "AI" is now table stakes, but no credible AI programme to point to. |
| 04 | Faculty bandwidth | No internal capacity to build or run an AI-native curriculum. |
| 05 | Admissions differentiation | Private colleges compete on marketing in every admission cycle. |

A 13-week **apprenticeship**. Not a course.

Built for engineering students. Integrated with tier-2 engineering colleges. Earned, not granted.



13

WEEKS

Total programme length

100

STUDENTS / COHORT

In pods of 8-12, one mentor each

0

LECTURES

They ship from week one



A week inside BuildAI looks like a week inside an AI startup.



A Wednesday in Week 6.

Not a class schedule. The actual rhythm of a working AI startup, lived by a 3rd-year engineering student.

●	09:00	Review PR comments	Mentor left feedback overnight on yesterday's PR. Student replies, pushes a fix, requests re-review.
●	10:30	Open GitHub issue	Linear ticket for new feature. Student writes a 3-sentence design note before touching code.
●	12:00	Build with Cursor	AI-assisted implementation. Half the code is generated; the student reviews and refactors every line.
●	15:00	Debugging session	Hallucinated API response in production. Student traces logs, writes a regression eval, ships fix in 45 min.
●	17:00	Review peer's PR	Cross-pod review. Student leaves 4 substantive comments on another student's submission.
●	19:00	Record Loom demo	3-minute walkthrough of what shipped today. Posted to public Demo Day archive.

Six modules. One route.

Organised around the capabilities AI startups actually hire for.

M0 WEEK 1 AI-Native OS Ship one working app by end of week 1.	M1 WEEKS 2 - 4 Product Engineering Two deployed apps with auth and database.	M2 WEEKS 5 - 7 AI Product Patterns One real AI-powered product.
M3 WEEK 8 Eval & Reliability Eval suite that catches regressions.	M4 WEEKS 9 - 10 Shipping in a Startup Team sprint with PR-reviewed code.	M5 WEEKS 11 - 13 Capstone Real product, real users.

Seven dimensions. Two reviewers. External industry validation.

01	Shipping velocity	SCORED 1 – 5
02	Engineering judgment	SCORED 1 – 5
03	Product thinking	SCORED 1 – 5
04	AI fluency	SCORED 1 – 5
05	Collaboration	SCORED 1 – 5
06	Debugging	SCORED 1 – 5
07	Communication	SCORED 1 – 5

→ EXTERNAL VALIDATION

At Week 13, working engineers from real AI-first startups review top portfolios independently.

Their feedback enters the final score — and they become the hiring pipeline.



Three tiers. Earned, not granted.

Only ~30% of every cohort earns Apprentice Certified or above. Scarcity is what creates startup trust.

~ **70%**

PARTICIPATED

Finished the programme, completed all assignments.

~ **20%**

APPRENTICE CERTIFIED

All 7 rubric dimensions scored 3 or higher.

~ **10%**

DISTINCTION

Top performers, externally validated, featured in BuildAI's startup review network.



What every Apprentice Certified graduate walks away with.

5+

Deployed products in public portfolio

3+

Live URLs with working demos

1

Capstone reviewed by AI startup engineer

13

Weeks of PR-reviewed real code

8+

Loom architecture walkthroughs

1

Eval suite demonstrating reliability



What your institution gets when you partner with BuildAI.

01

Credible AI programme

An AI-native offering your admissions team can point to immediately.

02

Industry partnership

Documented industry tie-up for NAAC, AICTE, and placement reports.

03

Student outcomes

Measurable GitHub portfolios. Real deployed products. Marketing assets you own.

04

Administrative margin

₹5,000–₹7,000 per enrolled student. Yours to keep.

05

Zero faculty burden

BuildAI runs the entire programme. Your faculty focuses on core curriculum.

06

Hiring network access

Top graduates introduced to BuildAI's startup review network.



Simple economics.

College keeps administrative margin. BuildAI runs the programme.

→ STUDENT FEE

**₹20K –
₹25K**

What students pay for the 13-week apprenticeship.

→ COLLEGE MARGIN

₹5K – ₹7K

Per enrolled student. Administrative + facilitation margin.

→ BUILD AI FEE

**₹15K –
₹18K**

Per enrolled student. Covers mentors, tools, ops, evaluation.

Per-cohort revenue for college $(100 \times ₹6,000) = ₹6 \text{ lakh}$

Two cohorts per year (summer + winter) **= ₹12 lakh annual margin to your institution**

Why BuildAI is not Newton School, upGrad, or Internshala.

	BuildAI	Newton School	upGrad	Internshala
Format	Apprenticeship	Embedded school	Video courses	Self-paced
AI-native?	Built-in	Bolted on	Generic literacy	Basic prompts
Evaluation	7-dim + external	Internal grading	Course completion	Auto certificate
Output	Public portfolio	Class projects	Certificate	Certificate
Pass rate	~70% (gated)	~90%+	~95%+	~95%+
Price	₹20-25K	₹3-5L	₹15-40K	₹2-5K



AI is reshaping how software is built. India can either supply this workforce — or be supplied by it.

→ WHAT I'VE SEEN

Working at an AI-native company in the US, I see what AI-first startups actually hire for. The gap between that profile and what Indian colleges produce is structural, not cosmetic. It is also closeable in 13 weeks if the apprenticeship is rigorous.

→ WHY ME

IIT Bombay gave me the engineering foundation. Cornell Johnson sharpened the operating lens. Founding an AI-native company taught me what shipping actually feels like.

→ WHY NOW

AI-assisted engineering is no longer a 5-year horizon. It is the workflow. The colleges that integrate it over the next 18 months will define their placement decade.

Built by a founder who has lived this gap.



Sharad Agrawal

Founder, BuildAI

IIT Bombay Masters, 2018

Cornell Johnson MBA, 2024

Currently Founder of an AI-native company in the US

→ FROM THE INTERNAL STRATEGY
DOC

"The single most important hire of the next 18 months is the India co-founder."



Pilot partnership process.

Four stops between this meeting and Cohort 01 launch.





Let's run a pilot together.

Even a 30-student first cohort produces public proof your institution can show.

SHARAD AGRAWAL

Founder, BuildAI

contact@meetskybloom.com · IIT Bombay '18 · Cornell MBA '24

→ NEXT COHORT

**Summer / Winter
2026**